ordered not to play his records on the air anymore; his records were taken from the stores; and he was no longer permitted to play with major orchestras in Moscow but was sent, if he was given any work at all, to the provinces to play. I mentioned the cases of Feltsman and others I'd heard about to Gorbachev and said I thought I would have a better chance of getting support for some of the things we might agree on in the future, such as increased trade, if his country eased some of its restrictions on ethnic and minority groups.

Gorbachev is an intelligent man and a good listener. He didn't comment on my remarks, but launched into criticism of the United States, saying, in effect, that I had no place talking about human rights in the Soviet Union because Americans lived under far worse conditions than Soviet citizens. He quoted statements by some of our more extreme feminists who claimed American women were downtrodden and argued that we treated blacks like slaves.

The "most basic human right," he said, "is everyone's right to a job." In the Soviet Union, everyone had a job—and that couldn't be said for the United States. (He didn't say that the Soviet people couldn't choose their jobs, that they had to do whatever the government told them to do—if they were handed a broom, they started sweeping.)

It seemed clear Gorbachev believed propaganda about us that he had probably heard all his life. In some things he said there was a grain of truth, but a lot of the "facts" he came armed with and cited so authoritatively about America —such as those about the treatment of blacks in the South —were long out of date, and he didn't know, for example, about the vast improvements we'd made in race relations. "Things have changed," I said, and told him what I had done in California as governor, appointing to policy-making and executive positions more blacks than all the previous governors put together. I spoke about the dynamic energy